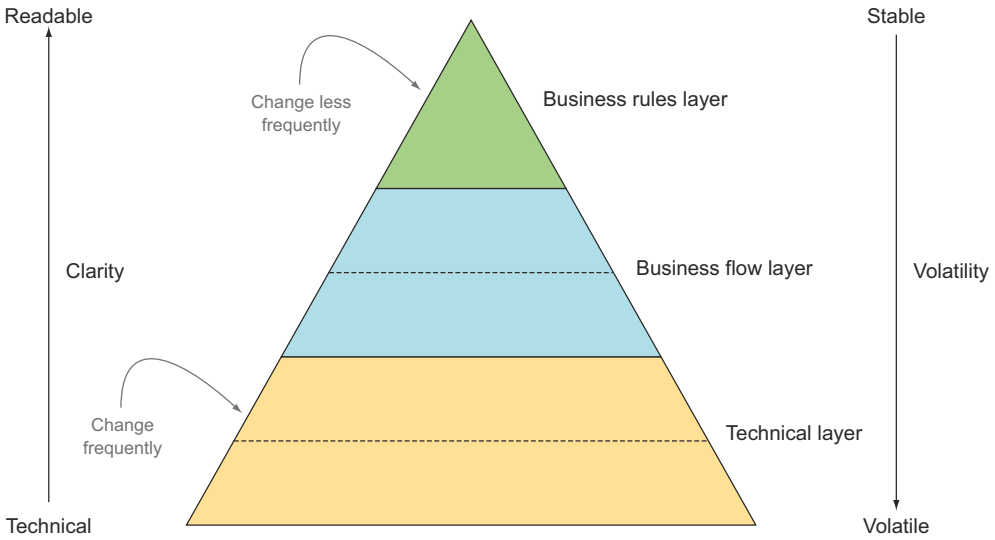


Figure 7.8 Well-written automated acceptance criteria are organized in three main layers.

Let's take a look at each of these three main layers.

7.3.1 The Business Rules layer describes the expected outcomes

The *Business Rules* layer describes the requirement under test in high-level business terms. If you're using a BDD tool such as JBehave, Cucumber, or SpecFlow, the business rule will typically take the form of a scenario in a feature file using either a table or a narrative structure, like the following:

```
Scenario: Registering online for a new Frequent Flyer account
Given Jane is not a Frequent Flyer member
When Jane registers for a new account
Then Jane should be sent a confirmation email
And Jane should receive 500 bonus points
```

The high-level action under test.

This rule only applies to new members.

1 The primary expected outcome.

2 Another expected outcome.

As you saw in the previous chapter, this sort of scenario focuses on the business outcomes of a requirement ❶ and ❷, and isn't too worried about how the system delivers these outcomes. Requirements expressed in this way should only need to change if the business changes its mind (or its understanding evolves) about the expected outcomes.

Figure 7.9 illustrates the way the Business Rules layer works together with the other two layers to implement this scenario. Don't worry about the details of the code just yet; we'll discuss the technologies used in this example later on in the chapter and in the following chapters.